

```
sarah@local:~$
```

File Architecture & Sorting Plan

Complete folder structure, file-type mapping, keyword tagging system, naming convention, and step-by-step automation guide to organise every file on your machine.



```
// 10 root categories · 42 subfolders · 80+ extension rules · 100+ keyword tags
```

SECTION 01

Master Folder Structure

```
sarah@local:~$ tree -d -L 2 ~/Sorted/
```

```
~/Sorted/
├── Legal/
│   ├── Court-Documents/
│   ├── Contracts/
│   ├── Correspondence/
│   ├── Evidence/
│   ├── ID-Certificates/
│   └── _Archive/
├── Banking/
│   ├── Statements/
│   ├── Invoices/
│   ├── Receipts/
│   ├── Tax/
│   ├── Insurance/
│   └── _Archive/
├── Design/
│   ├── PSD-Source-Files/
│   ├── Exports/
│   ├── Branding/
│   ├── Mockups/
│   ├── Fonts/
│   └── _Archive/
├── Templates/
│   ├── Documents/
│   ├── Spreadsheets/
│   ├── Presentations/
│   └── Design-Templates/
├── Screenshots/
│   ├── Desktop/
│   ├── Mobile/
│   └── Screen-Recordings/
├── Security/ # passwords & recovery
│   ├── Passwords/
│   ├── Recovery-Codes/
│   └── Licences-Keys/
├── Media/
│   ├── Photos/
│   ├── Videos/
│   ├── Audio/
│   └── GIFs-Stickers/
├── Documents/
│   ├── Personal/
│   ├── Work-Business/
│   ├── Reference/
│   └── Scans/
├── Projects/
│   └── {Project-Name}/
└── Assets/
```

```
| |─ Docs/  
| |─ Exports/  
| └─ Downloads/  
|─ Software/  
|─ Archives/  
└─ Unsorted/ # landing zone
```

```
// TIP: Every category has an _Archive/ subfolder (underscore prefix sorts it first). When a  
matter closes or project finishes, move files there instead of deleting.
```



SECTION 02

Category Breakdown

```
sarah@local:~$ cat .sort-rules --categories
```

LEGAL

~/Sorted/Legal/

SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Court-Documents	.pdf .docx	court, affidavit, motion, order, subpoena, magistrate
Contracts	.pdf .docx	contract, agreement, signed, NDA, terms, lease
Correspondence	.pdf .eml .msg	lawyer, solicitor, letter, notice, legal-aid
Evidence	.pdf .jpg .png .mp4	evidence, exhibit, proof, supporting, attachment
ID-Certificates	.pdf .jpg .png	licence, passport, birth-cert, ID, medicare

legal

court

contract

affidavit

evidence

solicitor

ID

matter-ref



BANKING & FINANCE

~/Sorted/Banking/

SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Statements	.pdf .csv	bank, statement, westpac, commbank, NAB, ANZ
Invoices	.pdf .xlsx	invoice, bill, payment, due, overdue, ABN
Receipts	.pdf .jpg .png	receipt, purchase, transaction, refund
Tax	.pdf .xlsx .csv	tax, ATO, BAS, return, deduction, super, PAYG
Insurance	.pdf .docx	insurance, policy, claim, premium, renewal

bank

westpac

commbank

NAB

ANZ

statement

invoice

tax

receipt



DESIGN

~/Sorted/Design/

SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
PSD-Source-Files	.psd .ai .indd .xd .fig	photoshop, illustrator, indesign, figma, source
Exports	.png .jpg .svg .webp .tiff	export, final, web, print, hi-res, crop
Branding	.psd .ai .svg .pdf	logo, brand, identity, guideline, palette
Mockups	.psd .png .jpg	mockup, preview, concept, draft, wireframe
Fonts	.otf .ttf .woff .woff2	font, typeface, typography, family

design

photoshop

illustrator

logo

export

mockup

font

branding

 TEMPLATES ~/Sorted/Templates/		
SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Documents	.docx .dotx .pdf	template, form, blank, reusable, letterhead
Spreadsheets	.xlsx .xltx .csv	template, tracker, budget, schedule, planner
Presentations	.pptx .potx .key	template, slides, pitch, deck, keynote
Design-Templates	.psd .ai .sketch .xd	template, canvas, layout, artboard, preset
template reusable blank form letterhead		

 SCREENSHOTS ~/Sorted/Screenshots/		
SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Desktop	.png .jpg .bmp	screenshot, desktop, capture, snip
Mobile	.png .jpg .heic	screenshot, phone, mobile, iOS, iphone
Screen-Recordings	.mp4 .mov .gif .webm	recording, screenrec, capture, clip
screenshot capture screen recording mobile		

 PASSWORDS & RECOVERY ~/Sorted/Security/		
SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Passwords	.kdbx .csv .1pux	password, login, credentials, vault, master
Recovery-Codes	.txt .pdf .png	recovery, backup, 2FA, MFA, seed-phrase
Licences-Keys	.txt .pdf .lic .key	licence, serial, activation, product-key
password recovery 2FA licence-key serial backup		

 PHOTOS & MEDIA ~/Sorted/Media/		
SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Photos	.jpg .png .heic .raw .cr2	photo, image, camera, portrait, event
Videos	.mp4 .mov .avi .mkv .wmv	video, footage, clip, reel, edit, render
Audio	.mp3 .wav .aac .flac .m4a	audio, music, recording, voicenote, podcast
GIFs-Stickers	.gif .webp .apng	gif, sticker, meme, animated, reaction
photo video audio music camera gif		

 DOCUMENTS ~/Sorted/Documents/		
SUBFOLDER	EXTENSIONS	TAGS
Personal	.pdf .docx .txt	personal, medical, NDIS, centrelink, resume
Work-Business	.pdf .docx .xlsx .pptx	business, ABN, report, proposal, minutes
Reference	.pdf .epub .md .txt	reference, guide, manual, how-to, notes
Scans	.pdf .jpg .tiff	scan, scanned, copy, certified, notarised
document personal medical business scan reference		



SECTION 03

Naming Convention

```
sarah@local:~$ echo $NAMING_FORMAT
```

```
YYYY-MM-DD_Category_Description_v1.ext
```

```
EXAMPLES:
```

```
2026-06-15_Bank_Westpac-Statement-June.pdf
2026-06-20_Legal_Affidavit-Supporting-Court.docx
2026-06-22_Design_Logo-Esve-Creative-Final_v3.psd
2026-06-25_Tax_BAS-Q4-2026.pdf
2026-06-28_Receipt_JBHiFi-Laptop.jpg
2026-06-29_Screenshot_Error-GoDaddy.png
2026-06-29_Project_EsveCreative_Logo-R2_v2.ai
```

```
// RULES:
```

- No spaces — use hyphens between words
- Always lead with date so files sort chronologically
- Add _v1, _v2 for versions. Use _FINAL only once
- Category prefix matches the root folder name

SECTION 04

Tagging System

```
sarah@local:~$ cat .tag-rules
```

FILE TYPE	ALWAYS TAG	+ CONTEXT TAG
Bank statement	bank, statement	westpac / commbank / NAB / ANZ
Invoice	invoice, payment	vendor name, due-date
Receipt	receipt, purchase	store name, amount
Court filing	legal, court	affidavit / motion, matter-ref
Contract	legal, contract	party name, signed / unsigned
Design source	design, source	photoshop / illustrator, project
Design export	design, export	web / print, dimensions
Screenshot	screenshot	desktop / mobile, app name
Photo	photo	event, location, people
Video	video	footage / edit, project name
Password file	password, security	service name
Recovery code	recovery, 2FA	service name
Template	template	doc / design / spreadsheet
Installer	installer, software	app name, version
Tax document	tax	ATO / BAS, financial year
Scan	scan	original type, certified / copy

// **HOW TO TAG:**

- **macOS:** Right-click → Tags (Finder colour tags + keywords)
- **Windows:** Right-click → Properties → Details → Tags
- **Cross-platform:** TagSpaces (free) – embeds tags in filename as [tag1 tag2]
- Apply 2-4 tags per file. Always include category + one context tag.



SECTION 05

Step-by-Step Sorting Plan

```
sarah@local:~$ ./sort-files.sh --plan
```

1 Create the folder structure

Build all 10 root folders and subfolders as shown in Section 01. I can generate a script that creates the entire tree in one click.

2 Gather everything into a staging area

Collect all scattered files into a single `/Unsorted` folder. Don't rename yet.

- Desktop, Downloads, Documents, Pictures, old hard drives
- Email attachments, cloud drive downloads
- USB sticks, phone transfers, random project folders

3 Automated sort — Pass 1: Extensions

First pass sorts by extension into the correct root folder:

- `.psd .ai .indd .fig` → `/Design/PSD-Source-Files/`
- `.otf .ttf .woff` → `/Design/Fonts/`
- `.exe .dmg .msi` → `/Downloads/Software/`
- `.zip .rar .7z` → `/Downloads/Archives/`
- `.mp4 .mov .avi` → `/Media/Videos/`
- `.mp3 .wav .flac` → `/Media/Audio/`
- `.kdbx .1pux` → `/Security/Passwords/`

4 Automated sort — Pass 2: Keywords

Second pass uses filename keywords to sort ambiguous files (`.pdf`, `.docx`, `.jpg`):

- `"statement" "westpac" "commbank"` → `/Banking/Statements/`
- `"invoice" "bill"` → `/Banking/Invoices/`
- `"receipt"` → `/Banking/Receipts/`
- `"affidavit" "court" "motion"` → `/Legal/Court-Documents/`
- `"contract" "agreement"` → `/Legal/Contracts/`
- `"screenshot" "snip"` → `/Screenshots/Desktop/`

5 Rename files to the naming convention

Apply `YYYY-MM-DD_Category_Description` format. Use file's modified date if original date is unknown. Batch-rename tools: PowerRename (Win), Renamer (Mac).

6 Apply tags

Tag files using keyword lists from Section 04. Priority: Banking and Legal first, then Design, then everything else. Automation can pre-tag based on destination folder.

7 Set up ongoing automation

Auto-sort new files as they arrive in Downloads:

- **Windows:** DropIt (free), File Juggler, or PowerShell script
- **macOS:** Hazel (paid), or Automator + Folder Actions
- **Either:** Python script as scheduled task / cron job

8

Weekly review — 5 minutes

Anything the automation can't sort lands in `/Downloads/Unsorted/`. 5 minutes weekly to move these. Refine keyword rules over time so fewer files end up here.



SECTION 06

Automation Rules Reference

```
sarah@local:~$ cat .sort-rules --verbose
```

Extension-based rules (run first)

EXTENSIONS	DESTINATION	NOTES
.psd .ai .indd .xd .fig	/Design/PSD-Source-Files/	design source files
.otf .ttf .woff .woff2	/Design/Fonts/	font files
.exe .dmg .msi .pkg	/Downloads/Software/	installers
.zip .rar .7z .tar .gz	/Downloads/Archives/	compressed
.mp4 .mov .avi .mkv	/Media/Videos/	unless "screen" in name
.mp3 .wav .aac .flac	/Media/Audio/	audio files
.gif .webp .apng	/Media/GIFs-Stickers/	animated media
.kdbx .1pux	/Security/Passwords/	password vaults
.lic .key	/Security/Licences-Keys/	licence files
.eml .msg	/Documents/Work-Business/	email files
.epub	/Documents/Reference/	ebooks
.heic .raw .cr2	/Media/Photos/	camera-specific

Keyword-based rules (override extensions)

KEYWORDS	DESTINATION	PRIORITY
screenshot, snip, screen shot	/Screenshots/Desktop/	HIGH
screen recording, screenrec	/Screenshots/Screen-Recordings/	HIGH
statement, bank-statement	/Banking/Statements/	HIGH
westpac, commbank, NAB, ANZ	/Banking/Statements/	HIGH
invoice, inv-	/Banking/Invoices/	HIGH
receipt	/Banking/Receipts/	HIGH
tax, BAS, ATO, PAYG	/Banking/Tax/	HIGH
insurance, policy, claim	/Banking/Insurance/	MED
affidavit, subpoena, court	/Legal/Court-Documents/	HIGH
contract, agreement, NDA	/Legal/Contracts/	HIGH
licence, passport, birth-cert	/Legal/ID-Certificates/	MED
template, blank-form	/Templates/Documents/	MED
mockup, wireframe	/Design/Mockups/	MED
logo, brand, identity	/Design/Branding/	MED
recovery, 2FA, seed	/Security/Recovery-Codes/	MED
password, credential	/Security/Passwords/	MED

